

Syria

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** March 29, 1980 **Usage:** National and Civil

An earlier version of the flag had three stars, in anticipation of a union incorporating Syria, Egypt, and Iraq



Red, white, black, and green are pan-Arab colors

The two green stars originally represented Syria and Egypt, although they are now said to represent Syria and Iraq

Asia



Syria was created after the dissolution of French colonial rule in 1946. From 1958–1961 it merged with Egypt to form the United Arab Republic.

In 1920, while still a French colony, Syria flew a green-white-green tribar with a French *Tricolore* in the canton. At independence this was changed to a green, white, and black tricolor, with three red stars for its provinces across its center. Its current red, white, and black pan-Arabic flag, was adopted when Syria became part

of the United Arab Republic, but with three stars.

On leaving the union in 1961, Syria briefly reverted to its original flag, before re-adopting the Arab Liberation colors in 1963.

The arms of Syria depicts the Hawk of Quraish. It is almost identical with the arms of Libya.

ARMS OF SYRIA

The shield is in the form of a national flag



The hawk was the emblem of the Quraish tribe to which the Prophet Muhammad belonged

The inscription reads—in Arabic—"Arab Republic of Syria"